

EDUCATION	University of California, Los Angeles Jan 2022 - Jun 2027 (expected) <i>Ph.D. in Operations Management</i> Dissertation Committee: Reza Ahmadi (co-chair), Sriram Dasu (co-chair), Terence Tao, Lieven Vandenberghe, Charles Corbett, Kumar Rajaram, Ali Fattahi Sharif University of Technology Sep 2016 - Jan 2021 <i>B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering</i>
INTERESTS	Research <i>Applications:</i> Sustainable operations, wildfire risk management, energy systems. <i>Methods:</i> Stochastic optimization, data-driven optimization, large-scale optimization, decision-focused learning, sequential decision-making. Teaching <i>MBA:</i> Business analytics, operations management, data science, statistics. <i>Ph.D.:</i> Optimization, stochastic processes, dynamic programming
WORKING PAPERS	A. Taghavi, A. Fattahi, S. Dasu, R. Ahmadi. <i>Preventing Catastrophic Wildfires: Annual Grid Inspection and Maintenance Plan.</i> Major revision at Operations Research; revision submitted. [SSRN] (Job Market Paper) Winner, POMS College of SCM Best Student Paper Award 2026 Best Flash Talk Award, Early-Career Sustainable Operations Workshop 2026 Finalist, INFORMS Service Science Best Student Paper Award 2026 Finalist, INFORMS PSOR Best Video Competition 2026 Finalist, INFORMS PSOR Best Paper Competition 2026 - Accepted for Humanitarian Operations (HOPE) Workshop 2026 - Media coverage: UCLA Anderson Review, POMS SCM Research Bites A. Taghavi, A. Fattahi, S. Dasu, R. Ahmadi. <i>Fair and Flexible Scheduling for Dynamic Energy Load Control under Stochastic Demand.</i> Under review at Management Science. [SSRN]
WORK IN PROGRESS	A. Taghavi, S. Dasu, R. Ahmadi. <i>Sequential Information Acquisition and Learning for Dynamic Interventions.</i> In preparation for submission to Operations Research. A. Taghavi, R. Ahmadi, S. Dasu. <i>Balancing Prevention, Suppression, and Mitigation in Wildfire Risk Management.</i> A. Taghavi, A. Fattahi, R. Ahmadi, S. Dasu. <i>Optimization with Expensive Parametric Subproblems: Asymptotic Convexity and Sparse Search.</i>
PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS	A. Taghavi, SH. Khaleghparast, K. Eshghi. <i>Optimal Agent Framework: A Novel, Cost-Effective Model Articulation to Fill the Integration Gap between Agent-Based Modeling and Decision-Making.</i> <i>Complexity</i>, 2021. [Link] A. Taghavi, AH. Sadeghi, H. Zare, SH. Khaleghparast. <i>Water Resources Dynamics: Chabahar Free-zone Case Study.</i> Proceedings of the International Conference on Industrial Engineering and Operations Management (IEOM), 2020. [Link] A. Taghavi, M. Basirati, E. Hassannayebi, M. Safarimajd. <i>Scenario Assessment for COVID-19 Outbreak in Iran: A Hybrid Simulation–Optimization Model for Healthcare Capacity Allocation.</i> (Book Chapter), 2022. [Link]

AWARDS AND HONORS

Winner, POMS College of SCM Best Student Paper Award 2026
Best Flash Talk Award, Early-Career Sustainable Operations Workshop, UT Dallas, 2026
Finalist, INFORMS Service Science Best Student Paper Award 2026
Finalist, INFORMS Public Sector Operations Research (PSOR) Best Video Competition 2026
Finalist, INFORMS Public Sector Operations Research (PSOR) Best Paper Competition 2026
 Selected Participant, Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan 2026 (29/132 selected)
 Five-Year Anderson Ph.D. Fellowship, UCLA
 UCLA Easton Center Research Award
 UCLA Academic Senate's Council on Research Grant
 UCLA Fink Center for Finance Grant
 UCLA Anderson DOTM Area Travel Grant

TALKS

Preventing Catastrophic Wildfires: Annual Grid Inspection and Maintenance Plan.

- Service Science Best Student Paper Award, San Francisco, CA (Nov 2026, scheduled)
- PSOR Best Paper Award Session, San Francisco, CA (Nov 2026, scheduled)
- PSOR Best Video Award Session, San Francisco, CA (Nov 2026, scheduled)
- HOPE Research Workshop, Notre Dame, IN (Sep 2026, scheduled)
- M&SOM Conference, Harvard Business School, Boston, MA (Jul 2026)
- POMS Annual Conference, Reno, NV (May 2026)
- Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI (Mar 2026) — Poster
- 4th International Smoke Symposium, Tallahassee, FL (Mar 2026)
- Early-Career Sustainable Operations Workshop, UT Dallas, Dallas, TX (Feb 2026)
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)
- SoCal OR/OM Day, Irvine, CA (May 2025)
- POMS Annual Conference, Atlanta, GA (May 2025)
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA (Oct 2024)
- Anderson School of Management, UCLA (Oct 2023)
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ (Oct 2023)

Fair and Flexible Scheduling for Dynamic Energy Load Control under Stochastic Demand.

- POMS Annual Conference, Reno, NV (May 2026)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UCLA Anderson School of Management

2023 – 2026

Teaching Assistant

- **Business Analytics with Spreadsheets** (MBA elective), Winter/Spring 2023–2026 (8 quarters), Prof. Reza Ahmadi.
Responsibilities: Held office hours; graded assignments and exams; assisted with homework and exam design; proctored final exams.
- **Data Analytics Industry Seminar** (MSBA), Winter/Spring 2026 (2 quarters), Prof. Felipe Caro.
Responsibilities: Graded coursework and tracked participation; guided students in preparing weekly presentations to industry guests; managed course announcements and related course logistics.

Sharif University of Technology

2019 – 2020

Teaching Assistant

- **System Dynamics** (graduate and undergraduate), Fall 2019.
Responsibilities: Designed homework problems; graded coursework; held office hours.
- **System Analysis I** (undergraduate), Spring 2020.
Responsibilities: Designed homework problems; graded coursework; held office hours.
- **Simulation Languages** (graduate), Fall 2020.
Responsibilities: Held office hours.

- **Computer Information Systems** (undergraduate), Spring 2020.
Responsibilities: Designed homework problems; graded coursework.
- **Statistical Quality Control** (undergraduate), Fall 2019.
Responsibilities: Led discussion sessions; designed homework problems.
- **Facility Planning** (undergraduate), Fall 2019.
Responsibilities: Graded coursework; held office hours.

SELECTED COURSEWORK

Optimization: Convex optimization, linear programming, large-scale optimization, dynamic programming, optimization theory, calculus of variations.

Learning and Data Science: Pattern recognition, reinforcement learning foundations, econometrics.

Probability and Statistics: Stochastic processes, queueing theory, Monte Carlo simulation, theoretical statistics, large-sample theory, high-dimensional statistics, measure theory.

SKILLS

Optimization: GAMS, CPLEX, AMPL.

Programming: Python, Java, MATLAB, C++.

Simulation: AnyLogic, Vensim, NetLogo.

Data Visualization: Tableau, Power BI

Languages: English, Farsi

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Journal Referee: Journal of Applied Research on Industrial Engineering.

Conference Session Chair: POMS 2026, INFORMS 2026.

Professional Memberships: INFORMS, POMS, IEEE.

Section and College Affiliations: INFORMS Energy, Natural Resources, and the Environment Section; INFORMS Service Science Section; INFORMS Technology, Innovation Management, and Entrepreneurship Section; POMS Colleges: Supply Chain Management, Sustainable Operations.

REFERENCES	Reza Ahmadi Professor of Decisions, Operations & Technology Management UCLA Anderson School of Management Los Angeles, CA, USA reza.ahmadi@anderson.ucla.edu	Sriram Dasu Professor of Data Sciences & Operations USC Marshall School of Business Los Angeles, CA, USA sdasu@marshall.usc.edu
	Kumar Rajaram Professor of Decisions, Operations & Technology Management UCLA Anderson School of Management Los Angeles, CA, USA kumar.rajaram@anderson.ucla.edu	Ali Fattahi Assistant Professor of Operations Management & Business Analytics Johns Hopkins Carey Business School Baltimore, MD, USA ali.fattahi@jhu.edu